

PEACE BEYOND UNDERSTANDING

Scripture-Based CBT Workbook
for Christian Women with Anxiety

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy + Biblical Truth
Thought Records | Exposure Hierarchy | Faith Practices

By Daniel Tesfamariam

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This workbook is for educational purposes and does not replace professional mental health treatment. Please seek help if needed.

Crisis: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline

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UNDERSTANDING ANXIETY

A Faith Perspective

Anxiety is your body's natural alarm system - it's not a character flaw.

Even godly people in the Bible experienced anxiety:

- David: 'When anxiety was great within me' (Psalm 94:19)
- Jesus: 'His sweat was like drops of blood' (Luke 22:44)
- Paul: 'I had no rest in my spirit' (2 Corinthians 2:13)

Anxiety becomes a problem when it:

- Persists beyond the actual threat
- Prevents you from daily activities
- Causes physical symptoms (racing heart, tight chest)
- Makes you avoid situations God calls you to

The good news: God offers peace AND practical tools work!

'Be anxious for nothing, but in everything by prayer...' Phil 4:6

This workbook combines evidence-based CBT with biblical truth.

IS ANXIETY A SIN?

Short answer: NO. Anxiety is not a sin.

Anxiety is a human experience, not a moral failure.

Jesus himself experienced distress (Mark 14:33-34).

What the Bible actually says:

- Phil 4:6 is an INVITATION, not a condemnation
- 1 Peter 5:7 says 'cast your cares' - acknowledging we HAVE cares
- Psalm 55:22 says 'cast your burden' - we carry burdens

Guilt about anxiety makes anxiety worse.

God meets us WITH compassion, not condemnation (Romans 8:1).

You are not broken. You are human.

Seeking help is wise (Proverbs 12:15).

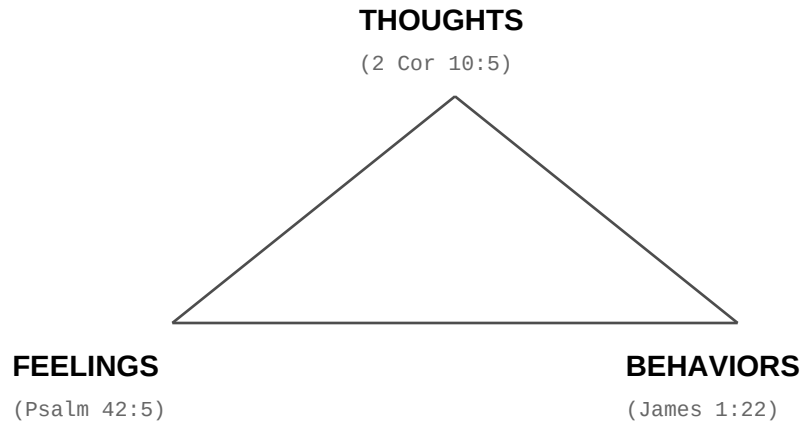
Therapy + faith can work beautifully together.

Write below: What guilt have you carried about your anxiety?

THE CBT TRIANGLE + SCRIPTURE

2 Corinthians 10:5 - Taking every thought captive

CBT teaches that our Thoughts, Feelings, and Behaviors are connected:



How it works:

Situation -> Automatic Thought -> Emotion -> Behavior

By changing our THOUGHTS (with truth), feelings and behaviors follow.

My example:

Situation: _____

My thought: _____

My feeling: _____

My behavior: _____

Biblical truth: _____

THOUGHT RECORD #1

Capturing & Challenging Anxious Thoughts

Situation (What happened?):

Automatic Thought (What went through my mind?):

Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

Evidence FOR this thought:

Evidence AGAINST this thought:

Balanced/Realistic Thought:

Biblical Truth (What does God say?):

New Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

THOUGHT RECORD #2

Capturing & Challenging Anxious Thoughts

Situation (What happened?):

Automatic Thought (What went through my mind?):

Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

Evidence FOR this thought:

Evidence AGAINST this thought:

Balanced/Realistic Thought:

Biblical Truth (What does God say?):

New Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

THOUGHT RECORD #3

Capturing & Challenging Anxious Thoughts

Situation (What happened?):

Automatic Thought (What went through my mind?):

Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

Evidence FOR this thought:

Evidence AGAINST this thought:

Balanced/Realistic Thought:

Biblical Truth (What does God say?):

New Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

THOUGHT RECORD #4

Capturing & Challenging Anxious Thoughts

Situation (What happened?):

Automatic Thought (What went through my mind?):

Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

Evidence FOR this thought:

Evidence AGAINST this thought:

Balanced/Realistic Thought:

Biblical Truth (What does God say?):

New Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

THOUGHT RECORD #5

Capturing & Challenging Anxious Thoughts

Situation (What happened?):

Automatic Thought (What went through my mind?):

Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

Evidence FOR this thought:

Evidence AGAINST this thought:

Balanced/Realistic Thought:

Biblical Truth (What does God say?):

New Emotion & Intensity (0-100%):

COGNITIVE DISTORTIONS & BIBLICAL CORRECTIONS

- All-or-Nothing Thinking

Romans 3:23 - All fall short; grace covers

- Catastrophizing

Matthew 6:34 - Do not worry about tomorrow

- Mind Reading

1 Samuel 16:7 - Only God knows the heart

- Fortune Telling

James 4:14 - You do not know what tomorrow brings

- Emotional Reasoning

Jeremiah 17:9 - The heart is deceitful

- Should Statements

Romans 8:1 - No condemnation in Christ

- Labeling

2 Cor 5:17 - You are a new creation

- Magnification

Psalms 103:12 - He removes our sins far away

- Personalization

Romans 8:28 - God works all for good

- Overgeneralization

Lam 3:22-23 - His mercies are new every morning

BEHAVIORAL EXPERIMENT #1

My anxious prediction:

What I will do (the experiment):

Prayer before:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

Updated belief (0-100% belief):

Scripture to remember:

BEHAVIORAL EXPERIMENT #2

My anxious prediction:

What I will do (the experiment):

Prayer before:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

Updated belief (0-100% belief):

Scripture to remember:

BEHAVIORAL EXPERIMENT #3

My anxious prediction:

What I will do (the experiment):

Prayer before:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

Updated belief (0-100% belief):

Scripture to remember:

EXPOSURE HIERARCHY

Facing fears gradually with God's strength

List your feared situations from least to most scary (0-100):

100%

90%

80%

70%

60%

50%

40%

30%

20%

10%

Start at the bottom. Each step builds courage. God is with you.

BREATHING AS PRAYER

1. Breathe IN for 4 counts: 'Lord, I receive your peace'
2. HOLD for 4 counts: 'You are here with me'
3. Breathe OUT for 6 counts: 'I release my anxiety to You'
4. Repeat 5-10 times

Scripture Breathing:

Inhale: 'The LORD is...' (Psalm 23:1)

Exhale: '...my shepherd'

Inhale: 'I shall not...'

Exhale: '...want'

Progressive Muscle Relaxation with Psalm 46:

Tense feet: 'God is our refuge...'

Release: '...and strength'

Tense legs: 'A very present help...'

Release: '...in trouble'

Continue up through body with the Psalm

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 1

Day	Mood(1-10)	Anxiety(1-10)	Prayer?	Scripture?	Exercise?
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Weekly Reflection:

What helped most this week?

God showed up by:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 2

Day	Mood(1-10)	Anxiety(1-10)	Prayer?	Scripture?	Exercise?
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Weekly Reflection:

What helped most this week?

God showed up by:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 3

Day	Mood(1-10)	Anxiety(1-10)	Prayer?	Scripture?	Exercise?
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Weekly Reflection:

What helped most this week?

God showed up by:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 4

Day	Mood(1-10)	Anxiety(1-10)	Prayer?	Scripture?	Exercise?
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Weekly Reflection:

What helped most this week?

God showed up by:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 5

Day	Mood(1-10)	Anxiety(1-10)	Prayer?	Scripture?	Exercise?
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Weekly Reflection:

What helped most this week?

God showed up by:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 6

Day	Mood(1-10)	Anxiety(1-10)	Prayer?	Scripture?	Exercise?
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Weekly Reflection:

What helped most this week?

God showed up by:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 7

Day	Mood(1-10)	Anxiety(1-10)	Prayer?	Scripture?	Exercise?
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Weekly Reflection:

What helped most this week?

God showed up by:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 8

Day	Mood(1-10)	Anxiety(1-10)	Prayer?	Scripture?	Exercise?
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Weekly Reflection:

What helped most this week?

God showed up by:

RELAPSE PREVENTION + SPIRITUAL DISCIPLINES

Warning signs my anxiety is returning:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

My spiritual disciplines that help:

Daily prayer time: _____

Scripture reading: _____

Church community: _____

Worship/Music: _____

Service to others: _____

My support team:

Therapist/Counselor: _____

Pastor: _____

Trusted friend: _____

Accountability partner: _____

FOR HUSBANDS: HOW TO SUPPORT HER

1. Listen without trying to fix. Just be present.
2. Don't say 'just pray more' or 'have more faith.'
3. Ask 'How can I help right now?' instead of assuming.
4. Learn her warning signs so you can support early.
5. Encourage her therapy - it's not a lack of faith.
6. Pray WITH her, not AT her.
7. Be patient. Recovery is not linear.
8. Celebrate small victories.
9. Take care of yourself too - you can't pour from empty.
10. Love her like Christ loves the church (Eph 5:25).

Ephesians 5:25 - Husbands, love your wives as Christ loved the church.

